On the backfoot, Krishna Aiyangar conceded that '[in] that year we might have committed mistakes. It was unfortunate. We had to start with debts. It was however an opportune moment the merchants wanted. It might have gone on well. They might have recouped. My sincere opinion was but for the competition they would have got over their initial difficulties.'

Next, Krishna Aiyangar was grilled on some financial matters by Sir John Biles, the details of which are not available. Finally, Krishna Aiyangar declared: 'Businessmen might think sometimes there was no sufficient capital and therefore it failed. But I challenge that this industry can never thrive so long as unfair competition is allowed.' He demanded that the government not only protect an infant industry but provide subsidies as well.

After the thrust came the turn when Froom pointedly asked if he felt any personal responsibility for the failure of the company. When S.D. Krishna Aiyangar denied any blame, he must have wept silent tears.